

Linus Torvalds releases the Linux kernel 4.5

The Linux kernel 4.5 has been released and one can read more about it on the 'Kernel Newbies' page. Linus Torvalds has been working on the Linux kernel 4.5 and now it has finally come to the market. The new kernel patch offers driver updates for USBs, Watchdog, GPU, RDMA, ATA, and sound; improvements for the ARM, x86, MIPS and SPARC architectures, and file system (Btrfs, CIFS, Ceph and JFFS2) enhancements.

The announcement was made by Linus Torvalds on the Linux kernel mailing list. Overall, everything is quite small and the diffstat appears slightly bigger for an xfs fix, as that fix comprises three clean-up refactoring patches preceding it.

There is also an access type pattern affixed to the sound layer which generates a lot of noise; however, it's pretty minor in the end. There are other random small fixes all over. The kernel comprises a shortlog, which is appended for people who would like to skim the details.

One can also get a great summary regarding all that is in the new version on the 'Kernel Newbies' page.

Google joins Facebook's Open Compute Project

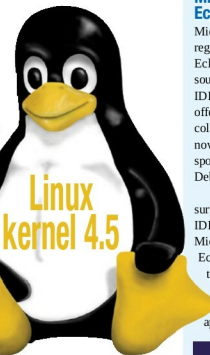
Facebook's Open Compute Project was aimed at accelerating the development of Internet hardware as well as to increase its uptake. The increase in demand would eventually drive down hardware costs.



San Jose, California, the search giant has also joined the project and is working with Facebook on new open source hardware.

As per Facebook's vice president of infrastructure, Jason Taylor, "The community and Google have inched closer and closer together."

Google's announcement is also indicative of other changes within the big Internet players. It marks the entry of artificial intelligence technology, which has been making rapid headway in many parts of the world.



Microsoft joins Open Source Eclipse Foundation

Microsoft has made an announcement regarding its association with the Eclipse Foundation, which is an open source group known for its Eclipse IDE offering. The foundation also offers many other developer tools. The collaboration implies Microsoft will now shake hands with other Eclipse sponsors like Google, Novell, IBM, Debeke and Oracle.

The announcement is a bit surprising as Microsoft offers its own IDE called Visual Studio. Besides, Microsoft plays an active role in the Eclipse ecosystem through its Azure toolkit for Eclipse, along with Java SDK for Azure which Eclipse users can utilise for building their cloud applications.



According to Microsoft's general manager, Shanku Niyogi, "We have worked with the Eclipse Foundation for many years to improve the Java experience across our portfolio of application platform and development services, including Visual Studio Team Services and Microsoft Azure."

The collaboration highlights Microsoft strengthening its role in the open source ecosystem. Also, the company has announced that it will be open sourcing its Team Explorer Everywhere plugin for Eclipse. Microsoft will be adding Azure IoT support to the Eclipse foundation's Kura IoT framework, and launching enhanced support for Java developers in Azure.